

Sam Cozart, RHP, UT

2026 stats: 1.72 ERA/52.1 IP/0.726 WHIP/77 K/13 BB/5.92 K:BB

6-6, 260

Metrics

FB: 94/19.7 IVB/6.4 HB/-4.58 VAA/6.6 ext/6.2 relH/50.5% zone/42.7 AA/37.4% usage/2230 rpm

CB: 77.3/-12.4 IVB/-9.1 HB/-9.95 VAA/29.5% zone/40.1 AA/16.5% usage/2530 rpm

SL: 85.5/3.3 IVB/-4 HB/-7.59 VAA/42.6% zone/35 AA/23.8% usage/2380 rpm

SWP: 80.1/1.7 IVB/-14.1 HB/-8.03 VAA/23.6% zone/28.5 AA/7.4% usage/2420 rpm

SPL: 80.1/-1.8 IVB/0.5 HB/-8.48 VAA/36.9% zone/39.5 AA/15% usage/1670 rpm

Write-up

The Freshman out of UT and the winner of the National Stopper of the Year award in 2026, Cozart is a physical specimen on the mound. The big bodied freshman was almost overqualified as the freshman closer for the Omaha bound Longhorns and made a massive impact in 2026 with 9 saves being awarded the highest award a reliever can be given this season. He looks the part of a Friday night starter but may wind up as the best Saturday arm in the country next year with Dylan Volantis occupying the weekend opener role for Texas. The ceiling is sky high with 3 plus secondaries and a plus fastball that he pounds the zone with. He is likely filled out so the ceiling will be established next year taking on a full starters work load. As of now, Cozart looks like 2/3 starter at the next level that has shown that his floor is a plus closer.

The FB, frankly, was unreal in 2026. Hitters were 8/68 against the pitch with a 38.7% whiff rate and 19.1% SWSTR. To highlight a specific moment for the freshman, he closed out a loaded Oregon Ducks lineup in the Austin Super Regional getting 5 of the 6 outs via the FB and 3 of those on Ks swinging. The final pitch of this 28 pitch master class was a 96 mph fastball with 19 inches of ride, powered by Ducks veteran and draft prospect Ryan Cooney. If you haven't watched those two innings, you should. Overall the pitch hit the zone an astounding 50.5% of the time but there was leakage into the heart of the zone. More pitches were elevated and the low fastballs generated called strikes more

than swings but a pitch with this raw of ride should live up in the zone. There is very little arm-side presence with the pitch leaning more to cut if anything. A true plus ride FB that is truly in a league of its own. If the results hold through a starter workload, this is a truly elite FB. 60/70 pitch

The CB is not the primary secondary Cozart uses, but it presented as an average to slightly above average pitch. It is slow and short but plays exceptionally off the FB with the high release leading to a steep finish. The feel for locating the pitch has not fully developed yet as a good deal of pitches were left up and arm-side rather than successfully buried beneath the zone. It failed to garner many swings and when swung at it was put in play at an above average rate. Despite all that, the pitch allowed a .095 avg. The pitch is in its infancy but will be a good strike stealer going forward if the command improves.

45/50+ pitch

The SL is a tight gyro pitch that gets good depth and average glove-side break. It's thrown hard sitting about 86 and topping at 89 while holding that plus depth. He is confident in the pitch and will throw it in all counts and is exceptional at getting it to the glove-side. UT calls the pitch a cutter and that is reflected in command trends. He will throw it up in the zone at times as opposed to being a bury-wipeout SL. Going forward, leaning into the gyro depth he creates will keep the pitch as plus. It pairs exceptionally off the FB as well getting a 45.5% chase rate. 60/60+ pitch

The SWP is a bigger version of his slider that Cozart does drop the arm slightly to get to the plus sweep the pitch gets. The slight tip didn't seem to help hitters as the pitch posted a 33.3% whiff and 35.7% chase on the season. The command to the glove-side was plus and was consistent in throwing the sweeper throughout the season in early count situations to RHH. There were some sweepers left up and away, getting the ball down would help the pitch as most whiffs were in the lower half or beneath the zone. 50/55 pitch

The SPL is an interesting shape with the average being near gyro and the spin rate being about 1700 on average. This spin rate is a by-product of Trackman's inability at times to read incredibly low spin rates. It's low on the season was beneath 700 and the pitch performs with the hard late depth of a low spin split. He often struggles to get the pitch down with a lot of heart misses through the year that resulted

in CS. The tunnel with the FB protects the pitch as hitters had to sit speed and couldn't adjust to the low spin split. The reliance on FB tunnel and suboptimal command dampen the grades. 50/55 pitch